DUBAI PODCAST STUDIO — PRODUCTION SYSTEM

The 24-Hour Content Pipeline.

A session-end-to-client-inbox production system that runs on 35 minutes of human effort per episode and delivers 8 content formats automatically. Built for a 6-person team. Scales without hiring.

HUMAN EFFORT
35 min per episode

DELIVERABLES
8 formats per session

DELIVERY TIME
24 hours

SOFTWARE COST
AED 590/month total

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00 — THE PRINCIPLE

This Is Not About Tools

THE MCDONALD'S MODEL APPLIED TO CONTENT PRODUCTION

McDonald's does not have better ingredients than a restaurant.
It has a system that produces the same result every time,
staffed by whoever is available, without creative judgment.

That is what this pipeline builds for DPS. Every session, same output. Same quality. Same 24-hour delivery. The engineer follows the SOP. The tools do the work.

THE CURRENT STATE — WHAT "NO PIPELINE" ACTUALLY MEANS

Right now, after a session ends, what happens is informal — someone edits the audio when they have time, the client follows up to ask where their files are, the Reels may or may not get done, there are no show notes unless the client writes them. The output depends on who is in the studio that day and how much time they have. **That is not a product. That is a recording space.** The pipeline converts DPS from a recording space into a content production company. Same studios. Same team. Completely different value proposition.

01 — THE SYSTEM

Step by Step — Session End to Client Inbox

0

During the Session — Set Up for Pipeline Success

This happens before the session even ends. 5 minutes of setup.

0 MIN EFFORT | PRE-SESSION

The pipeline only works if files are captured correctly from the start. Two rules that must be followed in every session:

Rule 1 — Consistent file naming: every session exported as `ClientName_EpNumber_YYYYMMDD` (e.g. `AlZaabi_Ep12_20261005`). This makes automation possible — the Make scenario triggers on this naming pattern.

Rule 2 — Record everything simultaneously: DAW captures audio, cameras capture video. Both recordings start at the same time using a clap or timecode. This one action eliminates sync work in post-production.

1

Export Raw Files — Session Ends

8 MIN · ENGINEER

Immediately after client leaves · 8 minutes

The engineer exports three things immediately while the session is still loaded:

1 — Final mix from the DAW (WAV 48kHz 24-bit) — the fully produced audio episode. This is the only creative editing step in the entire pipeline. The session mix template (EQ, compression, levels) is pre-built — the engineer only adjusts for this specific recording. Estimated time: 6 minutes.

2 — Video files from the ATEM/cameras — copy SD card files to the session folder. Plug in, copy, done. The camera recorded automatically throughout. 2 minutes.

3 — Upload both to the shared Google Drive session folder. This single upload triggers the Make automation that runs the rest of the pipeline.

- final_mix.wav
- camera1_wide.mp4
- camera2_closeup.mp4

2

AI Audio Enhancement — Fully Automatic

AUTOMATIC · 0 MIN

Runs in background · 0 minutes human effort

The WAV file is automatically processed through `Auphonic` via API trigger from Make.

Auphonic applies broadcast-standard audio processing in one step: noise reduction, level normalisation to -16 LUFS (podcast standard), removal of room echo, and loudness maximisation for streaming platforms.

This runs fully automatically in the background while the engineer has already moved on to the next session. Processing time for a 60-minute episode: approximately 8 minutes. Auphonic deposits the processed file back into the Google Drive folder when done.

Auphonic

Automatic audio levelling, noise reduction, speech enhancement, loudness normalisation. API integration means it runs without any human action. Used by BBC, Deutsche Welle, and thousands of professional podcast producers globally.

AED 90/month (unlimited hours) · auphonic.com

- final_mix_mastered.mp3
- -16 LUFS broadcast standard

3

Transcript + All Text Content — Mostly Automatic

5 minutes human setup, then runs automatically

95% AUTO | 5 MIN

Upload the mastered audio file to `Castmagic`. Select the client's language (English, Arabic, or bilingual). Click generate. Castmagic processes everything in approximately 10 minutes and outputs all of the following simultaneously — with zero additional work:

Castmagic

From a single audio upload, Castmagic generates: verbatim transcript with speaker labels, edited show notes (structured, professional), blog post (1,200–1,800 words), email newsletter draft, 10 social media posts (LinkedIn, Instagram, Twitter/X formats), 5 pull quotes, chapter markers with timestamps, and a 200-word episode summary. All outputs are editable and exportable as text files. Arabic language support is available — critical for bilingual DPS clients.

AED 150/month (Creator plan — 20 hours audio) · castmagic.io

- Full transcript
- Show notes
- Blog post
- 10 social posts
- Chapter markers
- Email newsletter
- Episode summary

4

Video Assembly — DaVinci Template

12 MIN · ENGINEER FOLLOWS SOP

12 minutes human effort · no creative decisions

Open `DaVinci Resolve` → Open "DPS Master Template" project. Import camera files. DaVinci's multi-cam sync tool automatically aligns all camera angles to the audio waveform — one click, done in 30 seconds. Apply the DPS colour grade preset (pre-built, saved in the template — never touch colour settings manually). Add lower thirds from the pre-built title template: client name, guest name, episode number. Pre-rendered DPS intro (5 sec) and DPS outro (10 sec) are already in the timeline — drag session footage between them. Export: `H.264, 4K, YouTube preset`.

The engineer makes zero creative decisions in this step. The template handles colour, graphics, and structure. The engineer only imports files, syncs, and exports.

DaVinci Resolve (free) + DPS Master Template

The DPS Master Template is a one-time setup investment: colour grade preset tuned to DPS studio lighting, lower-thirds graphics in DPS brand font and gold colour, pre-rendered DPS intro/outro, and export preset configured for YouTube, Instagram, and LinkedIn. Once built, every future episode uses the same template. Build time: 4 hours once.

AED 0 — DaVinci Resolve is completely free for everything this pipeline requires

- Full episode video 4K 16:9
- DPS branded intro/outro
- Lower thirds: names + episode number
- DPS colour grade applied

5

AI Reels Generation — Fully Automatic

AUTOMATIC · 5 MIN UPLOAD

5 minutes upload, then runs automatically · 0 wait effort

Upload the full video to `Opus Clip` (already in use at DPS). Opus Clip's AI identifies the highest-engagement moments — the "hook moments" in the conversation — and generates 5–8 vertical 9:16 clips automatically. Each clip has auto-generated captions synced to speech, branded with the DPS template set up in the account, and trimmed to 45–90 seconds (optimal for Instagram Reels, TikTok, LinkedIn, YouTube Shorts).

Processing time: approximately 25 minutes for a 60-minute episode, fully unattended. The engineer uploads, walks away, downloads when notified.

- 5 vertical Reels 9:16
- Auto-captions on each
- DPS branded frame
- 45–90 sec each

6

Thumbnail — Canva Template

5 MIN · ENGINEER FOLLOWS TEMPLATE

5 minutes · one decision only

Open the DPS Podcast Thumbnail template in `Canva Pro`. The template has the DPS visual structure pre-built: background, colour palette, font system, logo placement, and layout. The engineer makes exactly two changes:

1 — Swap the guest photo (take a screenshot from the video at a good frame). **2 —** Update the episode title text.

Export three sizes automatically: YouTube (1280×720), square for Instagram (1080×1080), and portrait for Stories (1080×1920). Total time: 5 minutes. Zero design skill required.

Canva Pro — DPS Thumbnail Template System

Build 3 master thumbnail templates once (one per DPS visual style). Each template has branded colours, fonts, logo, and layout locked. Engineer only swaps photo and title. Magic Resize feature exports all 3 sizes simultaneously from one click. Templates are reused indefinitely.

AED 180/month or AED 1,400/year · canva.com

- YouTube thumbnail 1280×720
- Instagram square 1080×1080
- Stories portrait 1080×1920

7

Client Delivery — Automatic Notification

FULLY AUTOMATIC · 0 MIN

0 minutes human effort · triggered by Make

When all files are deposited into the client's Google Drive folder, a Make scenario detects the completion (monitors for the final Reels file which is always the last to arrive), and automatically sends the client a branded email:

"Your episode is ready. Here's everything we produced from your session:" followed by a structured list with clickable links to each deliverable in their folder. The email goes out automatically — no human sends it, no human checks it. The client receives it within 24 hours of their session ending.

Make (already in use at DPS) — Delivery Automation Scenario

New Make scenario: Watch Google Drive folder for new file named "*_reels_done*" → Send formatted email from DPS email to client → Log delivery in Airtable (session record updated: "Delivered"). One scenario, runs every time, zero maintenance after setup. Build time: 45 minutes once.

AED 0 — uses existing Make subscription

02 — THE DELIVERABLE

What the Client Receives in 24 Hours

From one 60-minute recording session. This is the complete package that lands in their inbox. No chasing. No follow-up calls. No "where are my files?"

The DPS Content Package — Per Session

Delivered to client Google Drive folder + email notification within 24 hours of session

🎙️ **Mastered Audio Episode**
MP3 + WAV · -16 LUFS broadcast standard · noise-reduced · ready for Apple Podcasts, Spotify, RSS upload

🎬 **Full Video Episode**
4K H.264 16:9 · DPS colour grade · branded lower thirds · intro/outro · ready for YouTube direct upload

📱 **5 Vertical Reels**
9:16 · 45–90 sec each · auto-captions · branded frame · ready for Instagram, TikTok, LinkedIn, YouTube Shorts

📝 **Full Transcript**
Verbatim · speaker-labelled · timestamped · available in English and/or Arabic · .docx + .txt

📋 **Show Notes + Blog Post**
Structured show notes ready to paste into podcast host · 1,200-word SEO blog post · chapter markers with timestamps

📧 **10 Social Media Posts**
Formatted for LinkedIn, Instagram, and X · 5 pull quotes · email newsletter draft · ready to copy-paste and publish

🖼️ **Episode Thumbnail (3 sizes)**
YouTube 1280×720 · Instagram 1080×1080 · Stories 1080×1920 · DPS branded · client-ready

📊 **Episode Summary**
200-word episode description · ready for podcast host, YouTube description, and website · SEO-optimised

03 — THE SOP

Exactly 35 Minutes of Human Work

This is the Standard Operating Procedure. Any member of the DPS team can execute this after 30 minutes of training. No creative decisions, no judgment calls — just follow the steps.

STEP	ACTION	WHO	TIME	TYPE
1	Export final mix from DAW using session template. Name file correctly.	Engineer	6 min	Manual

STEP	ACTION	WHO	TIME	TYPE
2	Copy camera files from SD card to session folder. Upload both to Google Drive.	Engineer	2 min	**Manual**
3	Auphonic processes audio. Castmagic generates all text content.	Nobody	~15 min	**Automatic**
4	Upload audio to Castmagic. Select language. Click generate. Walk away.	Engineer	3 min	**Manual (upload only)**
5	Open DaVinci → DPS Master Template → import files → sync (1 click) → export.	Engineer	12 min	**Manual (template-driven)**
6	Upload full video to Opus Clip. Set clip count to 5. Start. Walk away.	Engineer	5 min	**Manual (upload only)**
7	Open Canva DPS template. Swap guest photo + episode title. Export 3 sizes.	Engineer	5 min	**Manual (template-driven)**
8	Drop all completed files into client's Google Drive folder. Done.	Engineer	2 min	**Manual (file move)**
9	Make detects completed folder → sends delivery email to client automatically.	Nobody	0 min	**Automatic**
Total human effort per episode			**35 min**	**8 formats delivered**

THE CRITICAL ONE-TIME INVESTMENT

This pipeline requires a one-time setup investment of approximately **2 working days**: build the DaVinci Master Template (4 hours), set up Canva thumbnail templates (2 hours), configure Make delivery scenario (1 hour), set up Auphonic API connection (1 hour), and configure Castmagic account with DPS brand voice guidelines (1 hour). After that, it runs indefinitely with zero maintenance. Every session from that point forward takes 35 minutes and delivers 8 formats.

04 — THE AUTOMATION LAYER

What Make Does in This Pipeline

DPS already uses Make for the Studio Network. This pipeline adds one new Make scenario that connects the production tools and handles client notification automatically.

1. **Trigger: New file uploaded to Google Drive session folder**
   Make watches the DPS Production Google Drive folder. When a new subfolder appears matching the naming pattern ClientName_EpNumber_Date, the scenario activates. This is the signal that a new session has started the pipeline.

2. **Action: Trigger Auphonic API — send audio file for processing**
   Make passes the WAV file URL to Auphonic's API with the DPS preset (noise reduction + normalisation to -16 LUFS). Auphonic processes and deposits the result back into the folder. Zero human action required.

3. **Action: Create client delivery folder with correct permissions**
   Make creates a dedicated client-accessible Google Drive subfolder, sets view permissions for the client's email address (pulled from Airtable — client records already there from the Studio Network), and prepares the delivery structure.

4. **Watch: Monitor for Opus Clip completion signal**
   Make watches for the Reels files to appear in the folder (named *_reel_1.mp4 through *_reel_5.mp4). This is the last file to arrive, confirming the full package is complete. When all 5 Reels are present, Make triggers the delivery step.

5. **Action: Send branded delivery email to client**
   Make sends a pre-built HTML email from the DPS email address to the client. The email lists all 8 deliverables with direct Google Drive links. Subject line: "Your [show name] Episode [number] is ready 🎙️ — everything's inside." Sent automatically, no human triggers it.

6. **Action: Update Airtable session record — status: Delivered**
   The client's session record in Airtable (already exists from the Studio Network setup) is updated with delivery timestamp, package contents, and status "Delivered." This creates a searchable history of every episode delivered — useful for client reviews, upsells, and the Dubai Podcast Index data.

05 — ECONOMICS

Cost, Pricing, and What It Changes

MONTHLY SOFTWARE COST

AED 590

Auphonic AED 90 + Castmagic AED 150 + Canva Pro AED 180 + Opus Clip AED 170 (existing)

COST PER EPISODE

AED 20

At 30 sessions/month. Drops to AED 12 at 50 sessions/month. Marginal cost approaches zero at scale.

ONE-TIME SETUP

2 days

Build templates, configure APIs, test full run-through. Done once. Runs indefinitely.

AUDIO SESSION — UNCHANGED

Base rate

CONTENT ENGINE — VIDEO SESSIONS

+AED 500

no change

- ✓ Mastered audio file
- ✓ Transcript
- ✓ Show notes
- ✓ 5 social posts
- ✓ Episode summary

add-on to base session rate

- ✓ Everything in Audio +
- ✓ 4K video episode (YouTube-ready)
- ✓ 5 vertical Reels (branded)
- ✓ 3 thumbnail sizes
- ✓ Blog post (1,200 words)
- ✓ Email newsletter draft
- ✓ 24-hour delivery guarantee

WHAT THIS CHANGES FOR THE BUSINESS

Currently DPS sells time — a room for an hour. After this pipeline, DPS sells output — 8 content formats, delivered in 24 hours, ready to publish across every platform the client uses. **The same 60-minute session now produces a week's worth of content for the client.** That is a fundamentally different value proposition. It is also one that no competitor can replicate without building the same system — and most will not bother, because it requires the tool integrations, the templates, and the Make automation working in sequence. Once it is built, it is an operational moat, not just a service feature.